

IT Shop Assistant – Speaking Practice

Explaining technical terms to a customer • Level B1

Aim of this worksheet

Oral exam 1 = As a client you must explain how you have used a computer in the past using the preterit and present perfect tenses. You will play the role of one of the clients below. /10

Oral exam 2 = Role play – client and shop assistant. During this rôle play you will play the shop assistant of Techropolis. You must explain technical terms to the client (played by your teacher) and sell a laptop. For this you must demonstrate you can use questions, the passive and active to describe functions and terminology. /10



Grammar reminder

Passive voice — for describing what something is used for / how it is made

- RAM is used to store data temporarily.
- This laptop has been designed for gaming.
- Storage is usually measured in GB or TB.

Present perfect — for describing experience, function and recent changes

- This processor has been tested for video editing.
- I've never had any problems with this charger.
- Manufacturers have improved NPU ratings a lot recently.

Complete the activities provided by your teacher for the preterit and present perfect.

Then write 200 words on how **you** have used a PC in the past.

When this is marked you can prepare for oral 1 – choose a client and imagine how he or she has used a PC in the past. Use the tenses and prepare to speak. (You may be asked questions about your experience so be ready!)

Exercise A — definitions

Match each term (1–14) with its definition (a–n). Write the letter next to the number.

Term	Your answer (letter)
1. Processor (CPU)	
2. Cores	
3. Threads	
4. USB-C	
5. USB-A	
6. Face recognition	
7. Bluetooth	
8. HDMI cable	
9. Charger wattage	
10. GB / TB (storage size)	
11. Pixel density (PPI)	
12. Gigahertz (GHz)	
13. RAM	
14. NPU rating	

Definitions (in random order)

- a) Short-term memory used to store data temporarily while programs are running.
- b) A wireless technology used to connect devices — like headphones or a mouse — over short distances.
- c) A small, reversible connector used for fast charging and data transfer; can be plugged in either way up.
- d) A measurement of how many pixels fit into one inch of a screen; a higher number means a sharper image.
- e) The amount of power (measured in watts) that a charger can supply; higher numbers usually mean faster charging.
- f) The older, rectangular connector found on many chargers, keyboards and older laptops.
- g) Units used to measure storage space; they show how many photos, videos or documents a device can hold.
- h) Virtual processing lines inside a core that let one core handle more than one task at the same time.
- i) A score that shows how powerful a chip's Neural Processing Unit is at handling AI-related tasks.
- j) Separate processing units inside the same chip; more of these let the computer do several tasks at once.

- k) A unit that measures a processor's clock speed — how many cycles it completes per second.
- l) A security feature that scans a person's face to unlock a device.
- m) The main chip that carries out instructions — often called the "brain" of the computer.
- n) A cable used to send both picture and sound from a computer to a screen or TV.

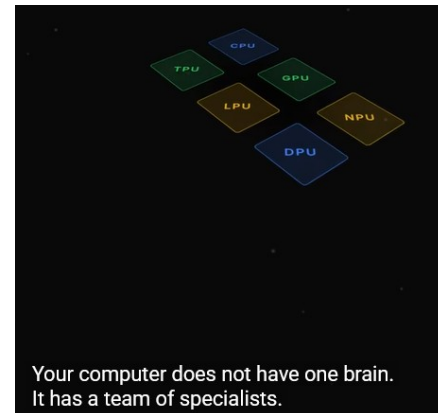
Listening and reading

Go to the following video on Youtube : https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=q3JCJwWm_JQ

Reduce the speed to 80 % and add English subtitles.

Work with a partner to write a definition and function for each of the following terms. Share the task to complete the work efficiently. (Collective Intelligence)

- CPU
- GPU
- TPU
- NPU
- LPU
- IPU
- DPU
- QPU



Exercise B — Passive voice: complete the definitions

Put the verb in brackets into the correct passive form.

1. RAM _____ (use) to store data temporarily while the computer is running.
2. USB-C _____ (design) so that it can be plugged in either way up.
3. An HDMI cable _____ (use) to send video and audio to a screen.
4. Charger wattage _____ (measure) in watts, and it tells you how fast a device will charge.
5. Bluetooth _____ (use) to connect two devices wirelessly over short distances.
6. Face recognition _____ (consider) a fast and secure way of unlocking a phone.
7. Storage capacity _____ (usually express) in GB or TB, depending on the device.

Exercise C — Present perfect: talking about experience and function

Put the verb in brackets into the correct present perfect form.

8. This laptop _____ (test) for gaming, and the results are very good.
9. I _____ (already / recommend) this charger to several customers because of its high wattage.
10. Manufacturers _____ (increase) NPU ratings a lot over the last two years.
11. We _____ (never / have) any complaints about this processor's performance.
12. Customers _____ (ask) me a lot recently about the difference between USB-C and USB-A.

Exercise D — Useful speaking frames for Oral 2

Use these frames to sound natural when you explain something to a customer. Practise using each one with at least two different terms from the list. Write a complete sentence for each one and get your teacher to mark it.

- Well, basically, a ... is used to ...
- It's been designed so that ...
- We've found that most customers who buy this ...
- In simple terms, this means that ...
- Compared to the older version, this model has been improved because ...
- I've personally tested this, and I can tell you that ...

Exercise E — Speak: explain it to a customer - Preparation Oral 2

Choose five terms from the list. For each one, prepare a short spoken explanation (2–3 sentences) using at least one passive form and one present perfect form.

Anticipate ! – with a partner write down at least five questions you could be asked by a client. (Remember you are the shop assistant at Techtropolis) (See grammar exercises on questions for help)

Practise with a partner: one of you is the customer, one is the assistant. (Use the PC PRO Magazine extract for the choice of laptops (with their specifications) that you can sell to the customer in the role play).

Oral exam role-play cards

One card per student. Each customer has a different focus together the six cards cover all 14 terms used in the PC PRO magazine extract. The questions under each client are **only** suggestions to help you to prepare but other questions **can** be asked. You will be asked follow-up questions if the explanation is too vague (e.g. "Can you give me an example?").

Customer 1 – The Gamer

Wants a laptop for gaming and streaming. Cares about speed and multitasking.

- "What exactly does the processor do, and why does it matter for gaming?"
- "What's the difference between cores and threads?"
- "This one says 3.2 GHz — is that fast?"

Customer 2 – The Photographer

Takes a lot of photos and videos and needs to store and view them.

- "How many photos and videos can 512GB actually hold?"
- "What does pixel density mean, and why does the screen look sharper here?"
- "Does more RAM help when I'm editing photos?"

Customer 3 – The Cautious Parent

Not very technical, worried about security and simple connections.

- "How does face recognition actually keep my phone safe?"
- "What's Bluetooth, and is it safe to leave it on?"
- "What's the difference between USB-A and USB-C? Which one do I need?"

Customer 4 – The Frequent Traveller

Needs to charge devices quickly and connect to hotel TVs/screens.

- "What does charger wattage mean — will a higher number charge my phone faster?"
- "Can I use this HDMI cable to connect my laptop to a hotel TV?"
- "Is USB-C the same in every country?"

Customer 5 – The AI-Curious Student

Has heard about 'AI laptops' and wants to know if it's worth it.

- "What is an NPU rating, and why do people say a laptop is 'good for AI'?"
- "Does more RAM matter if I'm running AI apps?"
- "Is a higher GHz always better?"

Customer 6 – The Undecided Buyer (final challenge)

Hasn't decided what they need — asks a bit about everything, in any order.

- "Can you just explain, in simple words, what makes this computer 'powerful'?"
- "What should I actually look at before I buy: GHz, RAM, or storage?"
- "Is there anything here that's outdated, like USB-A?"